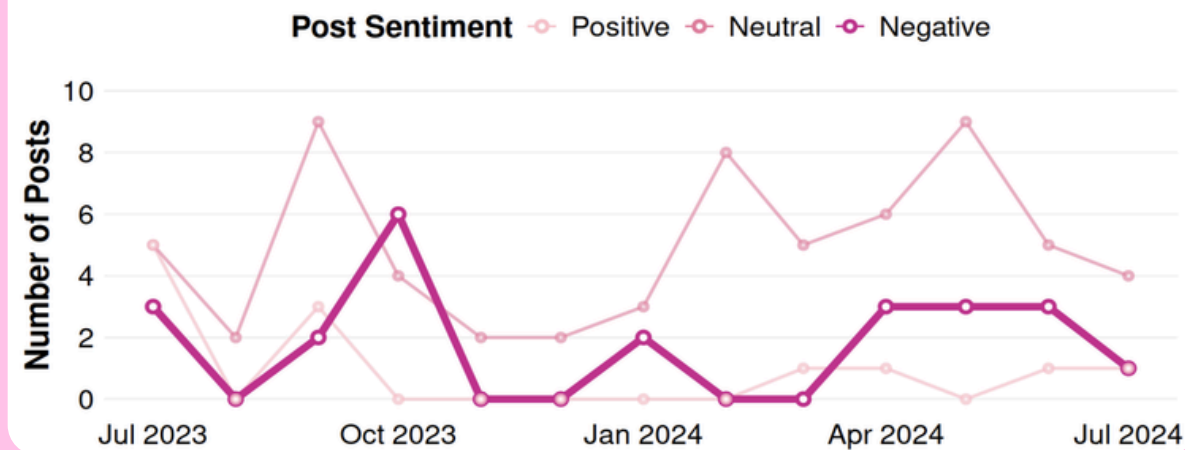


SENTIMENT SURROUNDING NEPHROLOGY POSTS

Persistence of Negative Patient Sentiments

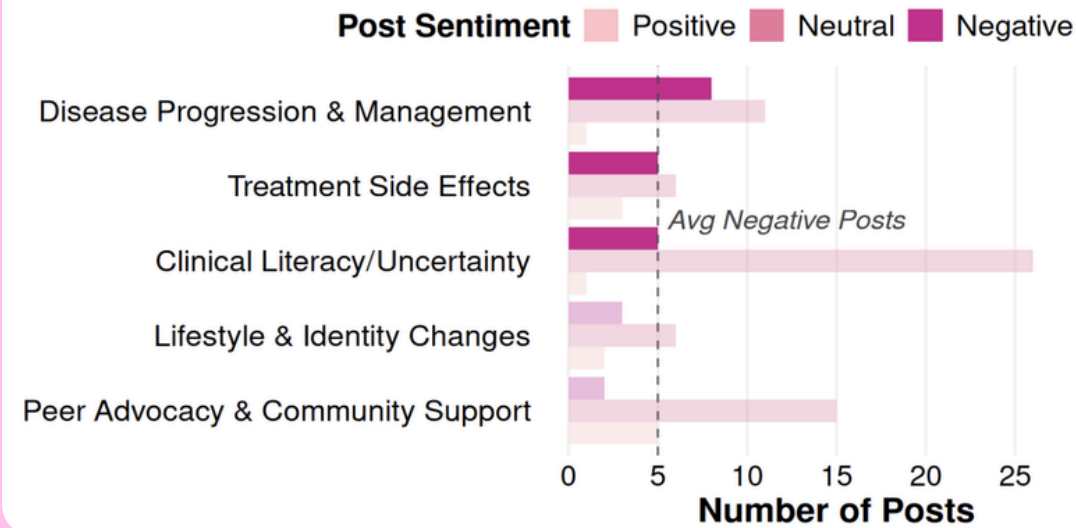
Total volume of nephrology-related posts per month (2023-2024)



The Discussion: Posts with a negative sentiment are where the main concerns of the community lie, and these remain persistent over time.

Common Nephrology Patient Discussions

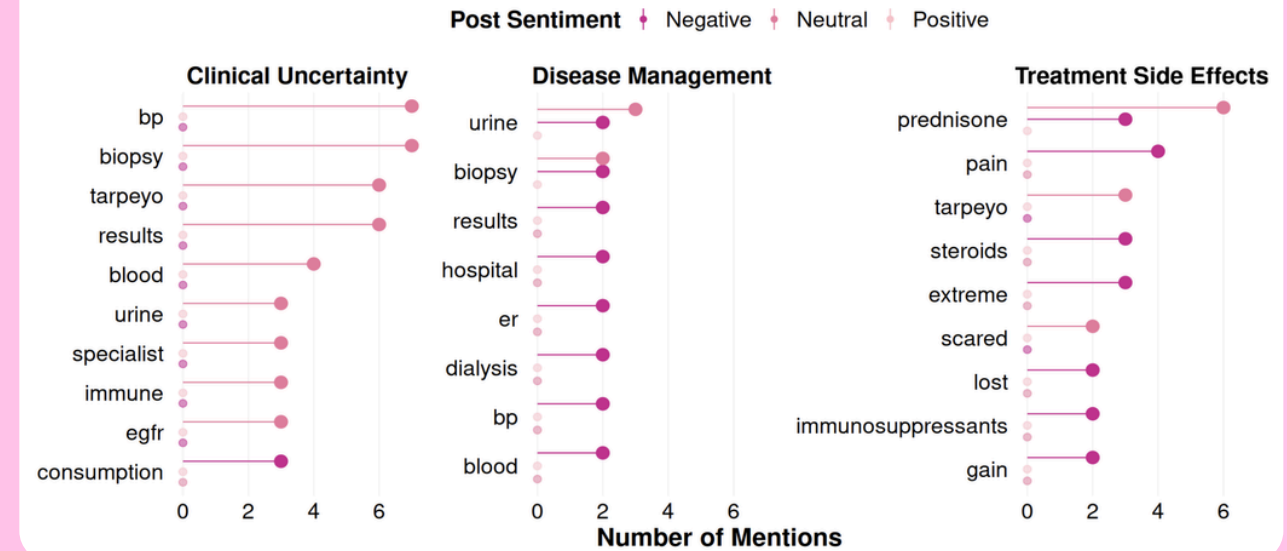
Top 3 categories ranked by negative sentiment



The Voice: From these topics, it's clear that many nephropathy patients are “scared” and “lost”. This reveals that steroid side effects take a physical and emotional toll on patients, and there is a strong need for clinical clarity surrounding biopsy and other test results.

Top Patient Concerns and Emotions

Top 10 most common words mentioned in each post category by sentiment



The Focus: Three categories drive the majority of community frustration. We focused our deep-dive here to understand the specific clinical and emotional barriers preventing positive patient experiences.

RESEARCH QUESTION

What are the primary drivers of persistent negative sentiment in the IgA Nephropathy patient community, and how can this information be used in the branding strategy for our new nephrology drug treatment?

HYPOTHESIS

If negative patient sentiment is primarily driven by struggles with clinical anxiety and steroid side effects, then our new branding must lead with empathy to address these areas and provide clarity where there is uncertainty.

DATA SOURCE: [UW x Real Chemistry](#)

METHODS

This dataset contains real Reddit conversations about kidney disease (nephrology) to show how patients speak about their symptoms, treatments, and decisions. We used R to analyze and find patterns within this dataset.

LIMITATIONS

The dataset mainly includes non-numerical values, and the sentiment and richness scores were initially automated estimates. We adjusted the post sentiments and categorized posts with common themes to provide a more accurate depiction of nephrology discourse.

KEY FINDINGS & BRAND IMPLICATIONS

The main nephrology patient frustrations include:

- The physical and emotional tolls of treatment side effects
- The anxiety of disease progression
- The confusion of clinical uncertainty

Text analysis from these posts reveal that “Prednisone” and “steroids” are often paired with words like “pain”, “scared”, and “lost”. Also, patients frequently turn to peers for help and advice with clinical questions and treatment results.

Our brand strategy must focus on leading with empathy for the patients who feel scared and lost, simplifying clinical uncertainty by providing clear and easy-to-understand resources, and positioning ourselves as a trusted guide.